HD Point, report, Landscape, Nigeria, 2026-10-30

Nigeria's National AI Strategy: five pillars, a 70% skills target and an execution gap

Key figures

Figure	Value	Basis	Claim
Youth AI-skills target	70 percent	Verified	c5
Nigeria	0.2 percent of GDP	Verified	c8
Global average	2.2 percent of GDP	Verified	c9

What was reported

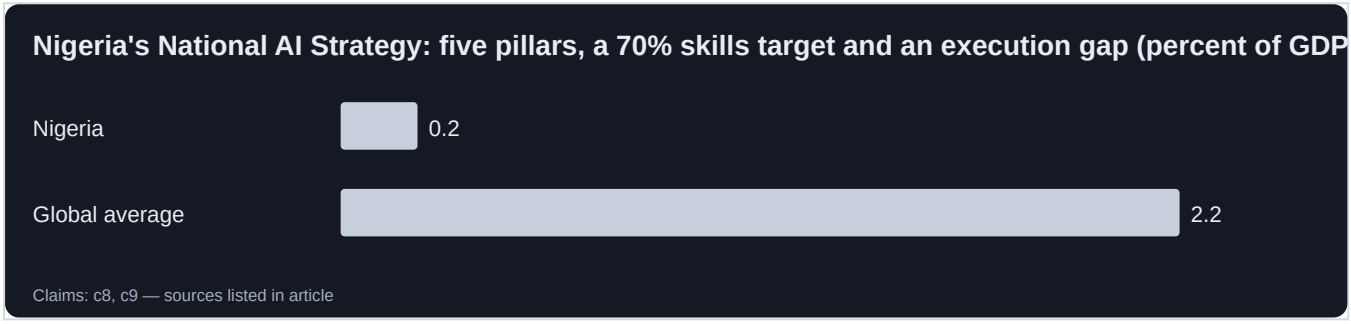
1. Nigeria launched its National Artificial Intelligence Strategy in Lagos in April 2025, according to Nairametrics. **Verified** c1
2. The strategy is built on five pillars: building AI infrastructure, fostering an innovation ecosystem, driving AI adoption across sectors, ensuring responsible AI development, and establishing robust governance. **Verified** c2
3. A four-day workshop in Abuja brought together over 120 AI researchers and practitioners to draft the strategy, according to the Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy. **Company says** c3
4. A draft of the strategy was published in August 2024. **Verified** c4
5. The strategy cites a target to equip 70% of youth with AI-related skills. **Verified** c5
6. Short-term items include setting up governance bodies, seeding demonstration projects, a national AI skills drive and pilot high-performance computing infrastructure. **Verified** c6
7. A policy brief by Tunani finds the strategy has few binding commitments, measurable targets or dedicated budget lines. **Verified** c7
8. The brief says Nigeria spends 0.2% of GDP on research and development. **Verified** c8
9. It puts the global average at 2.2% of GDP. **Verified** c9
10. The brief says Nigeria has advanced on talent, through the 3MTT programme and the N-ATLAS language model, but lags peers on infrastructure, governance and R&D spending. **Verified** c10

11. Minister Bosun Tijani has presented a vision for a National AI Trust at a convening hosted by Warwick Business School in London, describing it as the first institution of its kind in the world. **Verified** c11

12. He is also raising $2 billion for Project BRIDGE, an initiative to lay 90,000 kilometres of fibre-optic cable across Nigeria. **Verified** c12

13. In 2024 the ministry said Galaxy Backbone would partner with 21st Century Technologies on a national compute project open to local researchers, startups and government entities working on AI projects of national interest. **Company says** c13

Chart



How well sourced is this?

11 of 13 claims are supported by an independent source. 2 come from the company itself and have not been independently checked.

Source	Claims	Basis
https://nairametrics.com/2025/04/16/nigeria-launches-national-ai-strategy-to-drive-ai-development-and-productivity/	c1	Verified
https://regulations.ai/regulations/RAI-NG-NA-NAISNXX-2024	c2, c4, c5, c6	Verified
https://fmcide.gov.ng/hon-minister-dr-bosun-tijani-wraps-up-artificial-intelligence-strategy-workshop-announces-groundbreaking-partnerships-with-cisco-21st-century-technologies-others/	c3, c13	Company says
https://tunanihq.org/publications/nigeria-national-ai-strategy/	c7, c8, c9, c10	Verified
https://iafrica.com/nigeria-launches-vision-for-national-ai-trust-described-as-first-institution-of-its-kind-in-the-world/	c11, c12	Verified

About this report

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